NorthStar Goods

Monthly Performance Report

Period covered: December 2024 (vs November 2024)

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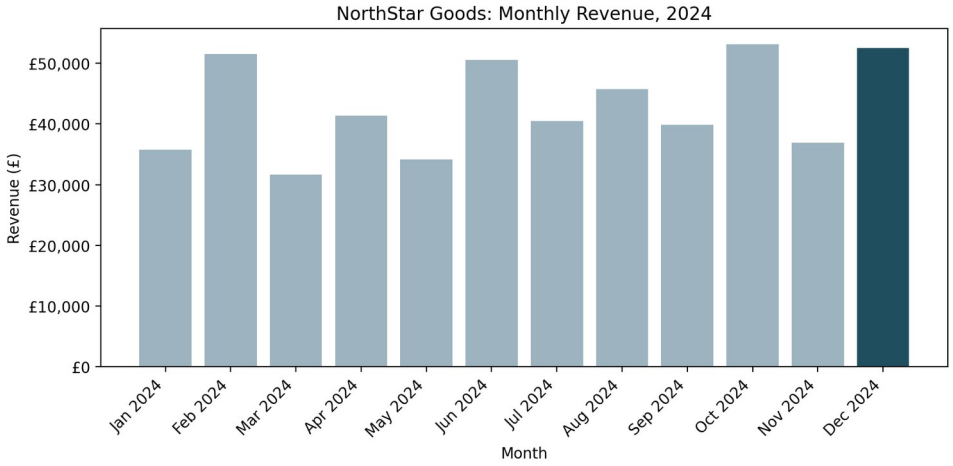
Executive Summary

1. **Revenue.** December revenue was £52,499.40, up 42.1% on November (£36,954.95) and the second-highest month of 2024. Orders rose from 67 to 90 and unique customers from 61 to 80.
2. **Categories.** Electronics, Beauty and Food & Drink added over £15,500 combined. Sports was the only category to decline (down 33.0%), falling from first to third place.
3. **Regions.** Six of eight regions exceeded the 5% month-on-month target. Scotland (28.46% below) and East (9.99% below) missed. Wales's 400% overshoot reflects a small November base and is not conclusive.
4. **Returns.** The return rate rose to 25.6%, against 17.9% in November and a full-year average of 23.8%. Clothing (50.0%) and Scotland (37.5%) were highest, on small order counts.
5. **Weekly pattern.** No meaningful day-of-week pattern emerged. December's variation is consistent with normal noise at this order volume.
6. **Priorities.** Investigate the Sports decline, review Clothing returns before the next buying cycle, and monitor Wales before drawing conclusions.

Findings

December revenue rose 42% on November, largely recovering a weak month

December revenue reached £52,499.40 across 90 orders, 42.06% above November's £36,954.95 across 67 orders, and second only to October (£53,116.90). Average order value rose from £551.57 to £583.33, and unique customers grew from 61 to 80. November was the second-weakest month of the year, so part of December's strength reflects recovery and not a new peak.

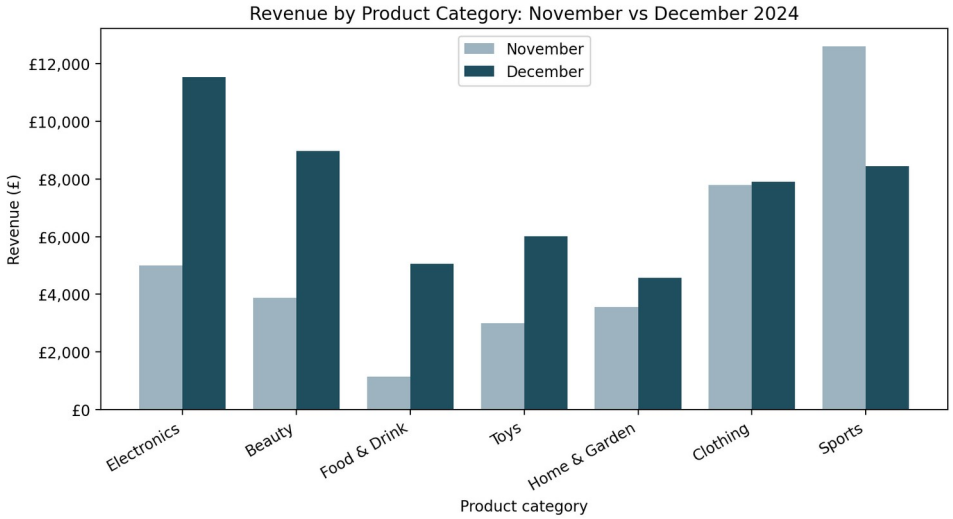


What this shows: *Monthly revenue across all of 2024, with December highlighted against the rest of the year.*

So what: *December is strong but not exceptional, and should be judged against the typical monthly range of £35,000 to £53,000 and not as a breakout result.*

Electronics, Beauty and Food & Drink drove growth, while Sports fell 33%

Electronics rose £6,535.51 (+130.8%), Beauty rose £5,096.47 (+131.5%), and Food & Drink rose £3,922.81 (+345.4%, from a small November base). Toys and Home & Garden also grew, by 100.4% and 28.6%, while Clothing was flat (+1.5%). Sports was the only category to decline, falling £4,152.68 (−33.0%) from the largest category in November to third place in December.

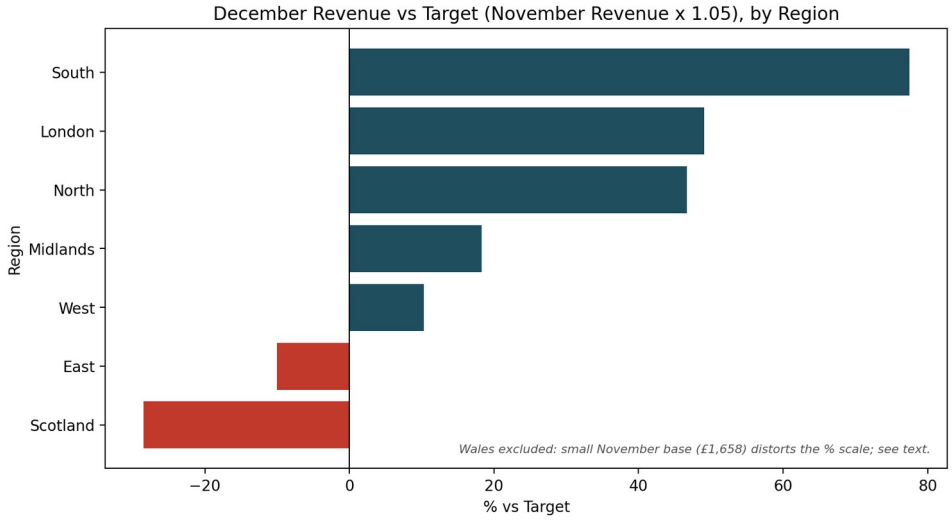


What this shows: *Revenue by product category, November versus December 2024.*

So what: *Sports' fall from first to third place warrants investigation before it becomes a trend, given its prior scale.*

Six of eight regions beat target, while Scotland missed by 28%

Each region's target was its November revenue grown by 5%, and six of eight regions exceeded it. South (+77.4%), London (+49.1%) and North (+46.7%) performed most strongly, with Midlands and West also ahead. East missed by 9.99% and Scotland by 28.46%, the largest shortfall of any region. Wales exceeded target by over 400%, but its November revenue of £1,657.81 was the lowest of any region, so the figure reflects a small base and not genuine strength.



What this shows: *December revenue versus a 5% month-on-month target, by region (Wales excluded from the chart, see text).*

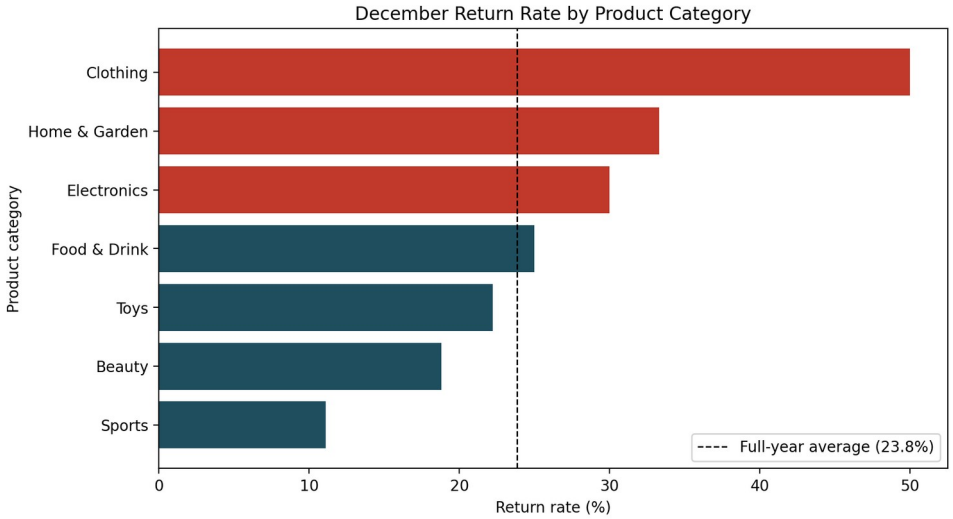
So what: *Scotland's shortfall is the largest of any region and, combined with its elevated return rate below, warrants a direct regional check-in.*

No reliable day-of-week pattern is visible

December revenue by day of week ranged from £6,241 on Fridays to £8,646 on Sundays across the month's 90 orders, an average of roughly 3 orders per day. Across the full year's 999 dated orders, however, the pattern is essentially flat, with average order value ranging only from £483 to £545. The December variation most likely reflects the small order count, and confirming a pattern would require several more months of data.

Return rate rose to 25.6%, led by Clothing and Scotland

This is a first, descriptive look at returns, to be followed by deeper analysis. December's return rate was 25.6% (23 of 90 orders), above November's 17.9% and the full-year average of 23.8%. Clothing was highest by category at 50.0% and Sports lowest at 11.1%, while Scotland was highest by region at 37.5% and Wales lowest at 10.0%. Each figure rests on 8 to 20 orders and should be treated as a directional signal, not a confirmed effect.



What this shows: *December return rate by product category, against the full-year average of 23.8%.*

So what: *A rising return rate alongside rising revenue can erode the margin benefit of a strong month if it continues into January, and Clothing's rate is the clearest early warning.*

Recommendations

1. Investigate the Sports decline. Sports led revenue in November and fell 33.0% in December. Reviewing pricing, stock availability and promotions against November would show whether this is a one-off dip or the start of a trend.

2. Review Clothing returns before the next buying cycle. At 50.0%, Clothing's return rate is roughly double the full-year average. Even on a small order count, a root-cause check on sizing, product description and fulfilment quality is warranted before volumes scale.

3. Open a regional review with Fiona MacLeod, Scotland's regional manager. Scotland missed target by 28.46% and has the highest return rate (37.5%), so the two issues may share a cause and should be addressed together.

4. Monitor Wales before acting on its December result. The 400% overshoot is a small-base effect. Track Wales for two to three more months before reallocating marketing budget or presenting it as a regional success.

Appendix: Data Sources and Caveats

This report draws on NorthStar Goods' cleaned order records (999 of 1,000 exported orders), combined with the regions reference list. One order (NS-00234) had an unreadable date and was excluded from all date-based analysis. Headline revenue figures were cross-checked against a separate database query and matched exactly. Region names and payment methods were standardised to correct inconsistent capitalisation. Two data-entry errors, an order of 500 units and another with a unit price of £9,999.99, were corrected using each order's recorded total and not removed. Breakdowns by region or category rest on small order counts, typically 8 to 20 orders per group, so these figures, return rates in particular, are directional and not statistically confirmed. Return status is examined descriptively only.